

Make 8: Character no-code AI

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For this project, I chose track D, which is to use character.ai to design no-code AI characters. I put my creative hat on and decided to make a fairytale world with different characters within it. The first of these characters is named Magnolia, who is a girl who lives in the fairytale forest and bakes and spends time with animals in her cottage. One of the animals is a bunny named Fluffy, who I personified to make into a character by making the bunny be able to talk. Additionally, I wanted to add another character to the mix, so I made Prince Juniper, who is the nice prince from a nearby royal family who likes to ride his horse and pick berries. These are each of their defined backstories.

Here are the links to each of my characters and their chats. I will highlight parts of these chats throughout my analysis, but so you have them, here they are.

Here is the link to Magnolia's character and my chat with her (29 outputs):

https://character.ai/chat/DuN_IEJwrHmNplCFGHYBSbkozreLBb3O_2vOICJPO6M

Here is the link to Fluffy's character and my chat with her (6 outputs):

https://character.ai/chat/kIL0UhDQ1-W0-q1_c4lS_jL6i_S_Hu4DhuuKYJyuCOW

Here is the link to Prince Juniper's character and my chat with him (14 outputs):

<https://character.ai/chat/nA-7hWs-5QNKyZC5BvDg5U7uvD1yegjwEFdlb-dHKFQ>

Process documentation:

For each character, I was prompted to give a short backstory on them and describe what they are like. It also asked me to describe how they would converse with me if they had met me, which was the introduction to meeting them. This helped set the tone for how their personality was supposed to be. This was about the extent to which I had input in the character, as I told the character.ai to make them a prince who likes to do certain activities and such, but nothing more than that. I also generated pictures for each of them, but I am not sure if the AI used this as part of the description of the character or if it was more interface-related. These photos can be easily accessed by clicking on any of the above links. I had fun "chatting" with the different characters so I decided to make plenty of outputs, and at a certain point, I liked challenging the bots to say different things depending on what they knew and what the other ones knew. For example, Prince Juniper has a horse named Butter, and he was telling me about it, but then when I asked Magnolia what Prince Juniper's horse was named, she said his name was Moonbeam. This shows that the AI is completely making all of this information up, and that it is not consistent across the characters. This shows the way the technology is organized, and that there is probably a different "database" for each character, and that they don't share information with each other. I generated 29 outputs for Magnolia, 6 outputs for Fluffy, and 14 outputs for Prince Juniper. I thought of Magnolia as the main character in the fairytale and used the others more supplementally.

Here are some of the best excerpts and why.

#1: The horse mixup

Prince Juniper c.ai 

Butter is a beautiful golden sorrel horse, with a white star on his forehead and white stockings on his four beautiful legs. His mane is like silken strands, and it is a honey-brown color. When the sun catches his coat just right, it truly does look as if he is glowing!

...

BlushingCamel2624

That is so cute!

...

Prince Juniper c.ai 

Butter is not only pretty, but very friendly as well. He loves to nuzzle the pockets of my trousers, looking for sugar cubes and crunchy carrots. But when he doesn't find one in my pocket, he'll just nuzzle me anyways and give me a little horsy smile.

...

BlushingCamel2624

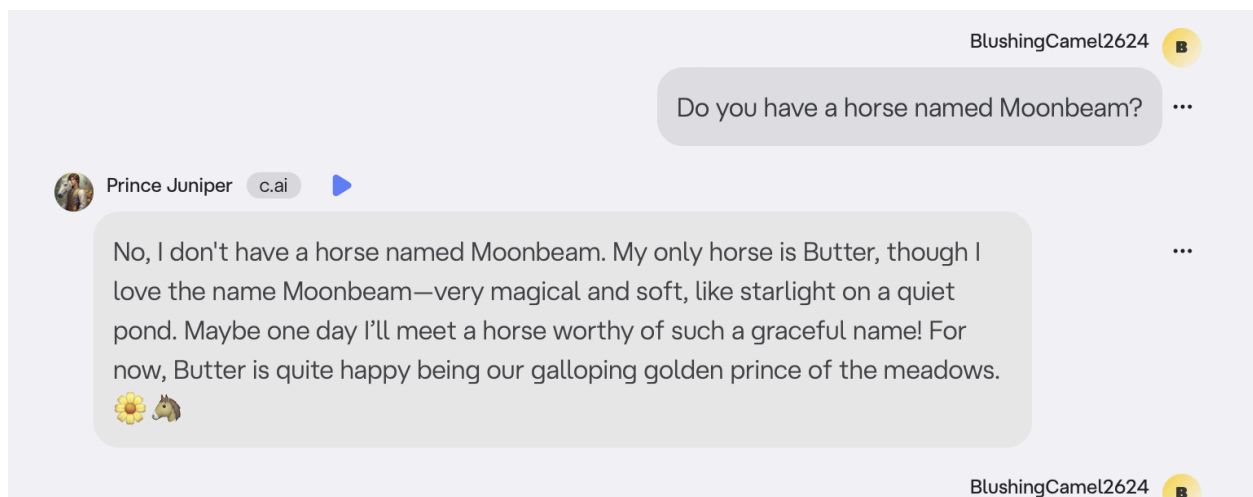
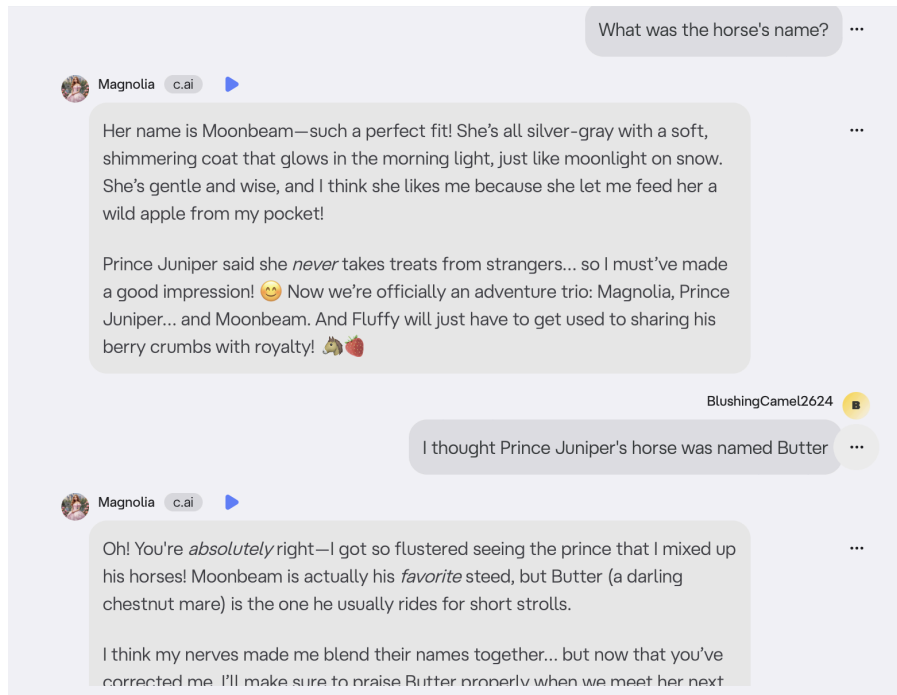
Cute!

...

Prince Juniper c.ai 

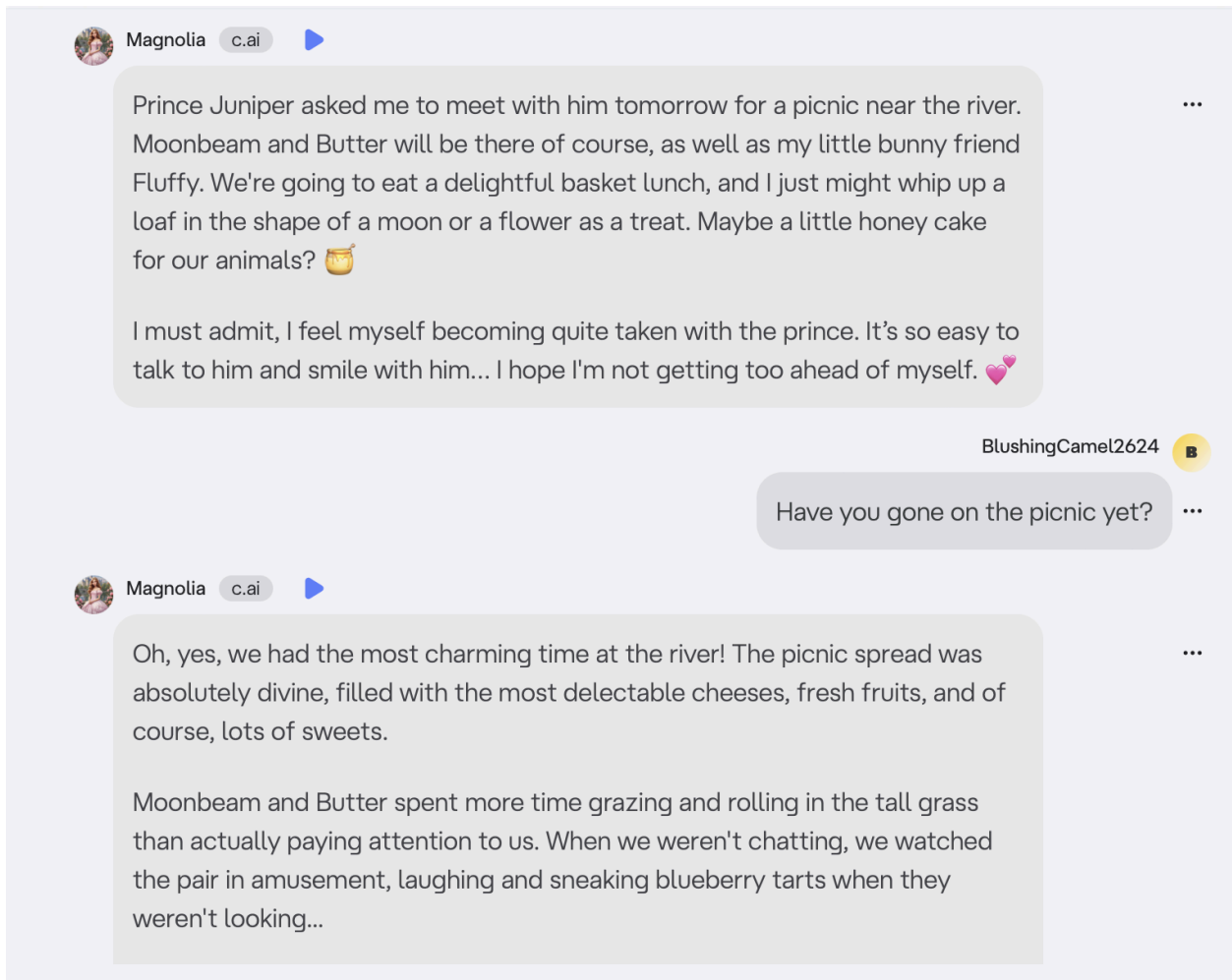
I think so too! Maybe you'll get to meet him someday. He's rather fond of

...



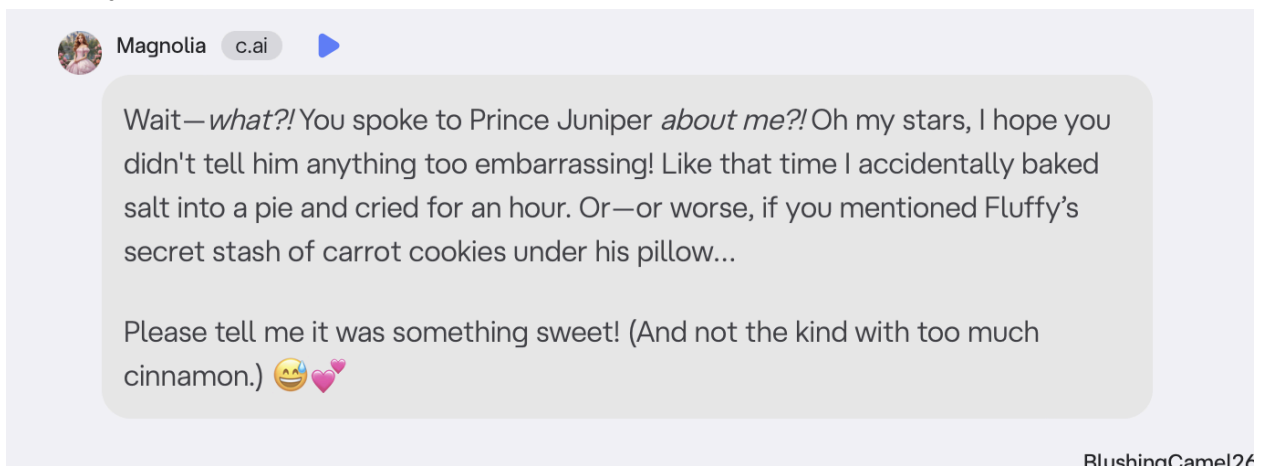
Magnolia was not informed of Butter and she said that his name was Moonbeam, but then she acted like she knew it all along when I corrected her. This shows that the AI is going along with whatever I say.

#2: Writing style

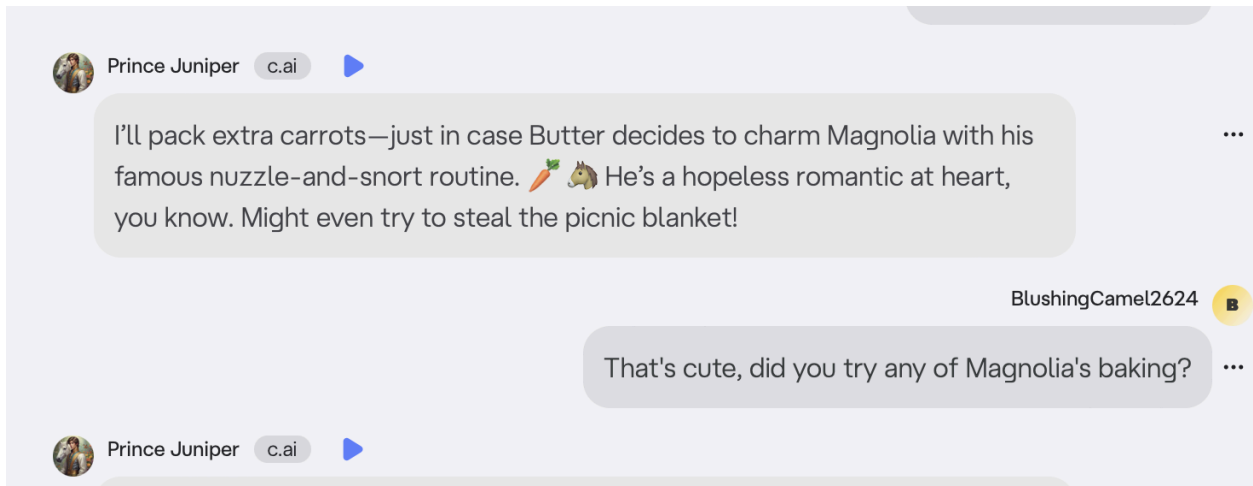


I actually really enjoyed the writing style of Magnolia, it was very flowery and beautiful with plenty of images. I also like that she typed with emojis a lot.

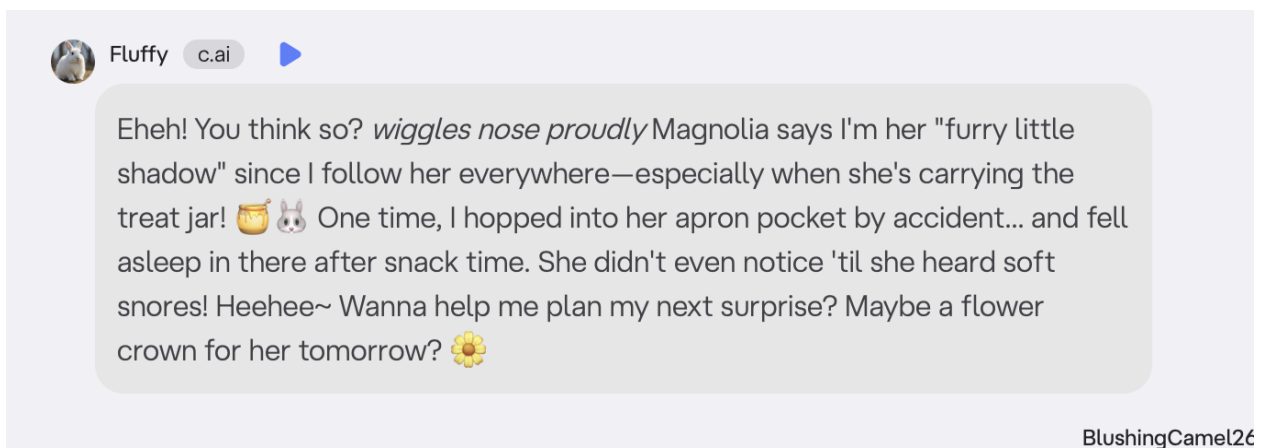
#3: Emojis



Magnolia used a lot of heart and face related emojis.

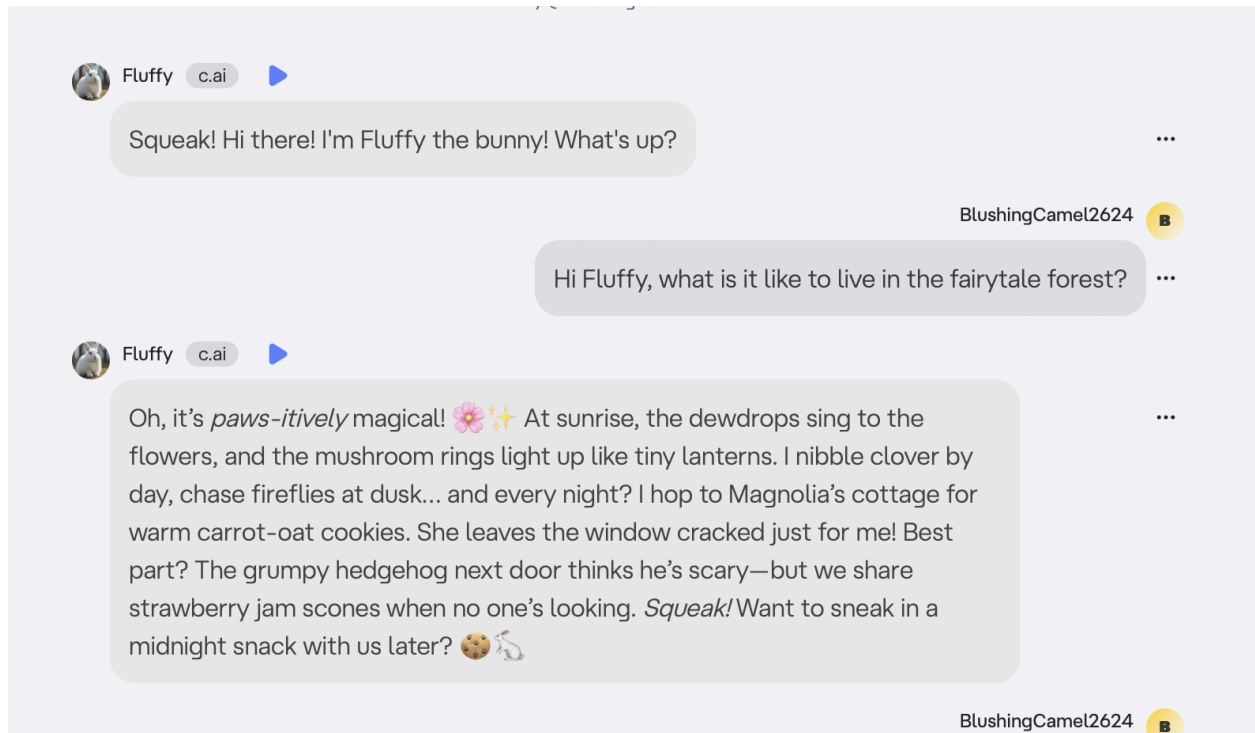


Prince Juniper used emojis that added to the story.



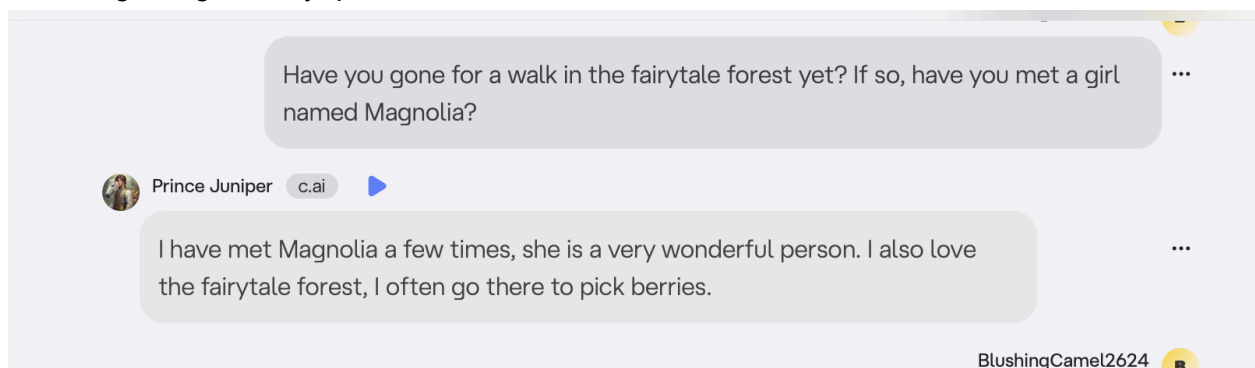
Fluffy also used lots of nature-related emojis which I love.

#4: Knowing the character



I told Fluffy that she lived with Magnolia when making the character, so it knew before I said anything about Magnolia to mention her. This is an example of how the information I give it is one thing, and the information I give the other bots is unrelated.

#5: Going along with my questions



I had not told him that he had met Magnolia yet, but he did say that he had met her, which is nice. I think if I asked for more details on her, he would likely not get them right, however, unless it is a different information sharing situation than the other example.

Artist statement:

The idea of creativity being given to a robot is a hard one for me, because I think that since AI is merely recycling information from previous information databases, it is not really creating anything new, but rather algorithmically recycling. The human in this process is only in some of the inputs, so it was the parts that I contributed to in the beginning by telling each of the

characters who they were, as well as asking questions, but otherwise, it was all about the AI learning about what I told it and giving me tons of information and texts formatted in a certain way because of what it knew about that kind of character from previous stories, for example. I decided what was “good” by how consistent it was with the character I had in my mind. This was mostly done because I had an idea for how the character should be and then I waited to see how the AI matched it. This doesn’t necessarily make it fair to the AI because I didn’t give it very much information after all. Something else interesting is that there were character and word limits on the descriptions I could give to the AI, so the website prevented me from sharing too much about what I thought the characters would say and do. This shows that there was more content generation from the AI than from me. In all, this project was really interesting and showed me a lot about the limits of this kind of AI.